

STARTER

Common Refusal Reasons & How to Avoid Them

New Zealand - Visitor Visa

Immigration New Zealand assesses each application against immigration instructions, focused heavily on whether you're a "genuine visitor" with a genuine, temporary purpose - not primarily a financial threshold test like some other countries.

The most common specific reasons

1. Not satisfying the "genuine visitor" requirement

INZ isn't convinced your visit is genuinely temporary, or that you'll leave before your visa expires. A vague or generic stated purpose, without a specific, credible plan, is a common and avoidable gap.

2. Insufficient funds against INZ's own guideline

- INZ publishes a specific per-month figure (see the Financial Requirements Overview) - falling short of it, or showing funds inconsistent with your stated trip length, is a direct refusal ground
- A sponsor's INZ 1025 form, where used, needs to clearly and credibly cover the gap - an informal letter doesn't carry the same weight

3. Weak ties to your home country

Evidence of employment, family, property, or ongoing study that gives you a genuine reason to return helps establish you're a temporary visitor, not someone planning to overstay.

4. Health or character concerns

A required chest X-ray, medical certificate, or police certificate that wasn't provided, or that raised a specific concern, can lead to refusal on its own, separate from your financial or intent evidence.

5. Incomplete or inconsistent application

Missing documents, or inconsistencies between your stated purpose, itinerary, and supporting evidence, undermine the genuine-visitor assessment even where your underlying case is otherwise fine.

LIMITED FORMAL APPEAL RIGHTS

Unlike most other countries in this catalogue, a standard Visitor Visa refusal generally carries no statutory right of appeal to the Immigration and Protection Tribunal, which mainly handles residence and deportation matters. See the Refusal Decision Guide (Premium tier) for what actually helps instead.